

SCALES SUCK > HALF WHOLE DIMINISHED SCALE

FROM DIGGING DEEPER JAZZ VIDEOS #39

Yup. Scales can be a drag. They are great for a lot of stuff, but as far as giving us some kind of organized basis for improvising, not so much. For instance, the alphabet doesn't help you speak, or form words in any real way, and scales are similar. Don't depend on scales to be some sort of "magic bullet" for your improvising. They suck at that! Now, you DO need to practice scales every day, work on them, analyze them, go nuts with them, and love and cherish them. Just realize that they suck!

When we begin to look for structure inside the scales, that's when we begin getting somewhere. Triads, chords, intervals that repeat, patterns lurking in there . . . those are things that can truly help us in our improvisation.

C Half Whole Diminished Scale

1 **C7(b9)**

1 b9 #9 3 #4 5 6 b7 8

2 **C7(b9)**

C TRIAD Eb TRIAD F# TRIAD A TRIAD

3 **C7(b9)** etc

4 **C7(b9)**

Caravan

(Latin)

A

4/4 C_{7b9}

C_{7b9}

C_{7b9}

F₋

Duke Ellington

4/4 C_{7b9}

C_{7b9}

C_{7b9}

4/4 C_{7b9}

Fine